"When to Refer to Disaster Spiritual Care" Wallet Card

Disaster Cycle Services Job Tools

Response / Disaster Spiritual Care

PURPOSE

The purpose of this resource is to help disaster workers be aware of what to listen for when talking to clients and when to refer clients and other disaster workers to Disaster Spiritual Care.

AUDIENCE

Required	Recommended
Disaster Health Services workforce	Division Disaster Executives
Disaster Mental Health workforce	Regional Disaster Officers
Disaster Action Team Members	
Red Cross Sheltering workforce	

INSTRUCTIONS

Disaster Spiritual Care, Disaster Mental Health, Disaster Health Services, and *Psychological First Aid* instructors use the following document to produce cards to hand out on all disasters. Disaster leaders may also print this tool to help their workforce know when to refer clients and fellow responders to Disaster Spiritual Care.

Cards can be professionally printed as 2-sided business cards or printed double-sided using Red Cross printers and cut into individual cards.

Distribute one card to each disaster worker during in-person training or on a disaster relief operation.

When to Refer to DSC

Clients may or may not be part of any faith, spiritual or religious community.

Refer to DSC

- Missing/deceased person/pet
- Hospitalized client or loved one
- Referral from Red Cross team or family
- Service or sacred ritual needed such as funeral or memorial

Refer to DSC (cont.)

- Client requests presence of own spiritual leader
- Client requests prayer or spiritual support from Red Cross
- Client requests replacement of lost religious article(s).

Client in danger of harming self/others, CALL 911 NOW and consult Disaster Mental Health.

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Risk Factors (Client or Staff)

- Felt threat to life
- Witnessed death/injury or civil unrest
- Separated from family or caregiver
- Community destroyed
- Assisted in rescue or recovery

Signs of Spiritual Distress

- Client asks "why me?"
- Where is God in this situation?
- What do I do next?
- Why did I survive?
- Client expresses guilt, anger, grief

Helpful Questions to Ask:

- How can we best support your spiritual needs?
- What helps you through difficult times?

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